



TOKEN GLOBAL PRESENCE: (From left) Turkish actor Meltem Cumbul, Shaji N. Karun, Hungarian filmmaker Márta Mészáros; Fudakowski

(Spring and Dew), directed by Makhonmani Mongsaba. But the toast of the selection were the Malayalam films, be it Adoor Gopalakrishnan's *Naalu Pennungal* (Four Women) or Lenin Rajendran's *Ratri Mazha* (Night Rain). The film that had everyone talking was Shyamaprasad's Mamooty-starrer *Ore Kadal* (The Sea Within), the opening film of the Panorama. Only two Hindi films were selected: Sameer Hanchate's *Gajla* and Bhavna Talwar's *Dharm*. The retrospectives on Tapan Sinha and Vijay Anand were well-received, with screenings of *Kabuliwalaah* and *Aadmi Aur Aurat* attracting huge crowds.

Filmmaker Shekhar Kapur flew in a day after his film *Elizabeth: The Golden Age* was released. Kapur, one of the people responsible for bringing IFFI to Goa, was visiting the festival after a gap of three years and could be seen flitting in and out of the Film Bazaar, organised by the National Film Development Corporation to initiate co-productions of small Indian films in the international market.

Most films screened at IFFI, however, had already reached the rest of the world. Mungiu's film was a winner at Cannes and India is the last country that the Academy Award-winning *Tsotsi* came to. In fact, Peter

BUZZ ON THE BEACH...

Director Jagmohan Mundhra, last in the news for the Aishwarya Rai-starrer *Provoked*, doesn't believe that charity begins at home. Mundhra is ready with his film *Shoot on Sight*, but he chose not to screen it at IFFI. Instead, he's going to premiere the film at the Dubai International Film Festival, which starts on December 9.

Only a few stray wanderers from the Kala Academy could be seen at the Adlabs jetty, the sole one at IFFI, this year. The jetty used to attract celebrities every year thanks to the Adlabs chief Manmohan Shetty's perennial presence. But ever since Shetty resigned, he has chosen to stay away from the sun and sand.

Fudakowski, the film's producer, says that more than an interest in screening the film, directors in India have asked him for remake rights. Which raised the question, will India ever be able to produce a truly global film? "Only if we make films rooted in our culture and language," said Kapur.

With the applause, there was heckling too, as members of the Film and Television Producers' Guild of South India raised objections to Goa being the venue and complained of poor organisation. About a hundred delegates were told their registration cards could not be found. "By the morning of November 24, everyone had a card," clarified Kapur. Others believe the registration process, which was strictly online, halved the number of delegates from 6,000 last year. Another new feature was the advance ticketing system. Registered members could select the films they wanted to watch and

were then issued tickets. While it eliminated chaos, glitches at the 15 counters, which delayed schedules, left many miffed. People also started hoarding tickets, which were free.

Pakistani director Shoib Mansoor's long but very brave *Khuda Kay Liye* was screened twice in one day and saw a packed house on both occasions, while Gerard Krawczyk's critically acclaimed French film *Taxi 4* saw a full theatre well before screening time. There was no mainstream Hindi film apart from beach screenings of *Chak De!*, *Dhoom 2* and *Fanaa*. The only film with superstars that made it to IFFI was Rituparno Ghosh's *The Last Lear*, starring Bachchan and Preity Zinta. That, after a fair bit of controversy, with the production house declaring that since the actors wouldn't be walking the red carpet, a screening made no sense. In the end, the Directorate of Film Festivals got its way, but *The Last Lear* had the last word.

